



Reply to your baby

At around nine months, your baby is likely to understand up to 20 familiar words that you regularly say to him, and he'll recognize your rhythm of speech. As a result, he may be including some new sounds, such as "t" and "w" when he's attempting to communicate with you. Pay attention to his babbling and reply by repeating his sounds and intonations back to him. He'll love this pretend conversation, and it will help him to become more confident in expressing himself.

This little piggy

Eight to nine months is a perfect age for your baby to enjoy the rhyme "This little piggy" and anticipate lots of tickles and laughter. Build the excitement by exaggerating your voice and actions as you count out each piggy on the toes of his foot and finish by tickling him all the way from the soles of his feet to his tummy:

This little piggy went to market,
This little piggy stayed at home,
This little piggy ate roast beef,
This little piggy had none,
And this little piggy cried
"Wee, wee, wee!" all the way home.

9
MONTHS

